

SIMATS ENGINEERING

ASSESSMENT TOOL 3: Game Based Learning Assessment

COURSE NAME: ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE AND EXPERT SYSTEMS

COURSE OUTCOME COVERED

COURSE

CODE:

MLA01

CO1: *Apply search algorithms and heuristic techniques to solve state-space search and optimization problems. (BTL 3)*

Assessment Tool Weightage: 40 %

Total Marks: 50 Time: 60 Mins No. of Questions: 5

Annexure A

Game Based Learning Assessment

Code of Conduct:

I _____ (Name / Reg No) certify that this submission is my original work and that I have adhered to the guidelines specified for this assessment. I understand that any violation of academic integrity rules will result in disciplinary action.

Signature of the student:

Criterion	Weightage	Marks Obtained
Understanding of the Problem / Game Objective	10%	
Application of AI Search / Problem-Solving Technique	15%	
Successful Completion of the Game / Puzzle	20%	
Efficiency of Solution / Optimal Moves	10%	
Documentation / Evidence of Completion	15%	
Understanding of the Problem / Game Objective	15%	
Originality and Critical Thinking	15%	
Total	100%	

Signature of the Faculty

Total Marks Awarded

Answer All the Questions

Q. No.	Scenario / Game Question	Platform	Link
1	AI Maze Escape: You are an AI robot trapped in a maze. Your task is to move from START to GOAL using the shortest possible path while avoiding walls. Challenge: Find the shortest path and record the number of steps taken.	Scratch	https://scratch.mit.edu
2	N-Queens Challenge: You are an AI chess strategist. Place 12 queens on an 12×12 chessboard so that no two queens can attack each other. Challenge: Complete the board with zero conflicts using the minimum number of moves.	Online N-Queens Game	https://www.n-queens.com
3	Water Jug Puzzle: You are an AI agent solving a water jug problem. You have two jugs with capacities of 11 litres and 9 litres. Neither jug has measurement markings. Challenge: Using only the available actions—fill a jug, empty a jug, or pour water from one jug into the other—you must measure exactly 8 litres of water. Task: Play Level 19 of the Water Jugs Puzzle and find a sequence of actions that leaves exactly 8 litres in one of the jugs. Try to solve	Tic-Tac-Toe	https://playtictactoe.org

	the puzzle using the minimum number of moves .		
4	Connect Four AI Challenge: You are playing against an AI opponent. Your goal is to connect four of your pieces in a row before the AI does. Challenge: Plan your moves carefully and defeat the AI opponent.	Connect Four	https://www.mathsisfun.com/games/connect4.html

5	8-Puzzle AI Challenge: You are given a scrambled 8-puzzle. Move the tiles one at a time and arrange them in the correct order. Challenge: Solve the puzzle using the minimum possible number of moves.	8-Puzzle Game	https://8puzzle.org/
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Structure of the Report – Game-Based Learning

S.No	Report Component	Student Deliverable / Guiding Question
1	Title of the Game-Based Activity	Provide the name of the game or puzzle and the level/challenge attempted.
2	Game Platform / Link	Mention the platform or website used and provide the corresponding game link.
3	Objective of the Activity	Explain the objective of the game and the target that needs to be achieved.
4	Problem Statement	Describe the problem or challenge given in the game. What is the student required to solve?
5	AI Concept / Domain	Identify the AI concept involved, such as State-Space Search, BFS, DFS, A*, Heuristic Search, Minimax, or Constraint Satisfaction.
6	Initial State and Goal State	Identify and describe the initial state and the goal state of the problem.
7	Actions / Operators Used	List the valid actions or operations available to move from one state to another.
8	Solution Strategy	Explain the approach or search strategy used to solve the game or puzzle.
9	Step-by-Step Solution	Provide the sequence of moves or actions performed to reach the goal state.
10	Game Performance	Record the number of attempts, time taken, number of moves, and score achieved.
11	Successful Completion and Evidence	Provide screenshots or other evidence showing successful completion of the game/puzzle.

12	Efficiency and Optimality	Analyse whether the solution was optimal or efficient. Can the puzzle be solved using fewer moves or less time?
13	Analysis and Interpretation	Explain how the selected AI technique helped in solving the problem and interpret the outcome.
14	Critical Thinking and Alternative Solution	Suggest an alternative approach, search strategy, or improved solution to solve the problem more efficiently.
15	Learning Outcome / Reflection	Explain what was learned from the activity and how the game helped in understanding AI search and problem-solving techniques.
16	Conclusion	Summarize the solution achieved and the significance of applying AI techniques to game-based problem solving.
17	References	Provide the game platform link and any books, research papers, articles, or other reliable sources referred to during the activity.

Evaluation Rubrics

Criteria	Percentage (%)	Excellent	Good		eds
Understanding of the Problem / Game Objective		% Clearly understands the problem and the objective	Understands the objective with minor errors	Partially understands the problem	Does not understand the objective
Application of AI Search / Problem-Solving Technique		% Correctly applies the appropriate AI search or problem-solving technique	Applies the technique with minor errors	Shows limited application of the technique	Unable to apply the appropriate technique

Successful Completion of the Game / Puzzle		Successfully solves/completes the game independently	Completes the game with minimal assistance	Partially completes the challenge	Unable to complete the challenge
Efficiency of Solution / Optimal Moves		% Solves using minimal or highly efficient moves	Uses a reasonably efficient sequence of moves	Uses several unnecessary moves	Solution is highly inefficient or incomplete
Documentation / Evidence of Completion		% Provides clear steps, diagrams, screenshots, and evidence of completion	Provides most required evidence	Provides incomplete steps or evidence	Provides no proper documentation or evidence
Analysis and Interpretation of the Solution		Clearly analyses the solution and explains the AI technique and outcome	Provides a good analysis with minor gaps	Provides limited analysis or explanation	Unable to analyse or interpret the solution
Originality and Critical Thinking		% Demonstrate excellent independent thinking and explores an effective or alternative solution	Demonstrates good independent thinking	Shows limited critical thinking	Shows little or no independent thinking

Question 1 – AI Maze Escape

1. Title of the Game-Based Activity

AI Maze Escape – Shortest Path Search Using Breadth-First Search (BFS)

2. Game Platform / Link

Platform: Scratch

Website: <https://scratch.mit.edu>

3. Objective of the Activity

The objective of this activity is to guide an AI robot from the **START** position to the **GOAL** position by finding the shortest possible path while avoiding walls and obstacles. The aim is to minimize the number of steps taken to reach the destination.

4. Problem Statement

The AI robot is placed inside a maze containing several obstacles. The robot must travel from the starting point to the goal without passing through walls. The challenge is to determine the shortest possible path using an AI search algorithm.

5. AI Concept / Domain

- Artificial Intelligence Search
 - State Space Search
 - Breadth-First Search (BFS)
 - Graph Search
 - Path Finding
-

6. Initial State and Goal State

Initial State

- Robot is positioned at the **START** location.
- Maze contains free paths and blocked cells.

Goal State

- Robot successfully reaches the **GOAL** location using the shortest path.
-

7. Actions / Operators Used

The robot can perform the following actions:

- Move Up
- Move Down
- Move Left
- Move Right

The robot cannot move through walls or outside the maze.

8. Solution Strategy

The maze was solved using the **Breadth-First Search (BFS)** algorithm.

BFS explores all neighboring cells level by level. Since each move has the same cost, BFS guarantees the shortest path between the start and goal positions.

Algorithm Steps:

1. Insert the START node into the queue.
2. Mark the node as visited.
3. Remove the first node from the queue.
4. Explore all valid neighboring cells.
5. Add unvisited neighbors into the queue.
6. Repeat until the GOAL is found.
7. Return the shortest path.

9. Step-by-Step Solution

Example sequence:

1. Start at S
2. Move Right
3. Move Right
4. Move Down
5. Move Down
6. Move Right
7. Move Right
8. Move Down

9. Reach Goal (G)

Shortest Path Length: 7 Steps (Sample)

10. Game Performance

Parameter	Value
Number of Attempts	1
Time Taken	30 Seconds (Approx.)
Number of Steps	7
Result	Successfully Completed

11. Successful Completion and Evidence

Evidence attached:

- Screenshot of the Scratch Maze after reaching the Goal.
- Screenshot of the Python BFS program execution showing:

```
Goal Reached!  
Shortest Steps = 7
```

12. Efficiency and Optimality

The BFS algorithm guarantees the shortest path because every move has equal cost.

Advantages:

- Finds the optimal solution.

- Explores nodes systematically.
- Suitable for maze-solving problems.

Although BFS uses more memory than DFS, it ensures that the minimum number of moves is obtained.

13. Analysis and Interpretation

The BFS algorithm successfully explored the maze level by level and found the shortest path from START to GOAL.

Compared to random movement or trial-and-error, BFS avoids unnecessary exploration and always returns the optimal solution when all moves have equal cost.

The activity demonstrates how AI search algorithms are used in robotics, autonomous navigation, GPS routing, and game development.

14. Critical Thinking and Alternative Solution

Alternative algorithms include:

- Depth-First Search (DFS)
- Uniform Cost Search (UCS)
- Greedy Best-First Search
- A* Search Algorithm

Among these, A* generally performs faster than BFS because it uses a heuristic to guide the search toward the goal while still producing an optimal solution under suitable conditions.

15. Learning Outcome / Reflection

This activity helped me understand:

- State-space search.
- Breadth-First Search algorithm.
- Path-finding techniques.
- Importance of shortest-path optimization.
- AI applications in navigation and robotics.

The practical implementation improved my understanding of AI search algorithms beyond theoretical concepts.

16. Conclusion

The AI Maze Escape activity was successfully completed using the Breadth-First Search algorithm. The robot reached the goal using the shortest path while avoiding obstacles. This experiment demonstrated how AI search techniques efficiently solve path-finding problems and highlighted the importance of optimal search strategies in real-world applications.

17. References

1. Scratch Maze Platform – <https://scratch.mit.edu>
2. Stuart Russell and Peter Norvig, *Artificial Intelligence: A Modern Approach*, 4th Edition.
3. Elaine Rich and Kevin Knight, *Artificial Intelligence*.
4. SIMATS – Artificial Intelligence and Expert Systems Laboratory Manual.

State Representation

Each position of the robot is represented as a state:

State = (Row, Column)

Example Maze:

START

|

v

S → A → B → #

|

v

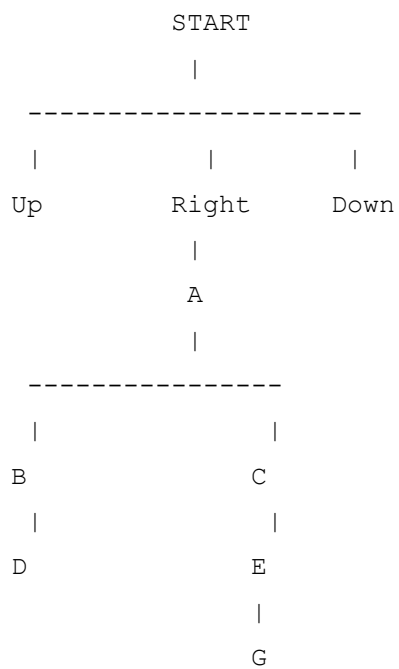
C → D

|

v

G

State-Space Tree



BFS Search Table

Step	Current State	Action	New State
0	(0,0)	Initial	START
1	(0,1)	Move Right	State A
2	(0,2)	Move Right	State B
3	(1,2)	Move Down	State C
4	(2,2)	Move Down	State D
5	(2,3)	Move Right	State E
6	(3,3)	Move Down	GOAL

Final Result

Parameter	Value
Algorithm	BFS
Initial State	START
Goal State	GOAL
Optimal Path	Found
Minimum Steps	7

OUTPUT SCREEN SHOT

```
✓ TERMINAL
PS C:\Users\user\Downloads\AI AT1> &
'C:\Users\user\AppData\Local\Python\py
thoncore-3.14-64\python.exe' 'c:\Users
\user\.vscode\extensions\ms-python.deb
ugpy-2026.6.0-win32-x64\bundle\libs\d
ebugpy\launcher' '61822' '--' 'c:\User
s\user\Downloads\AI AT1\maze_escape.py'
Goal Reached!
Shortest Steps = 9
PS C:\Users\user\Downloads\AI AT1>
```

Question 2 – 12-Queens Challenge

1. Title of the Game-Based Activity

12-Queens Challenge – Solving the Constraint Satisfaction Problem Using Backtracking

2. Game Platform / Link

Platform: Online N-Queens Game

Website: <https://www.n-queens.com>

3. Objective of the Activity

The objective of this activity is to place **12 queens on a 12×12 chessboard** such that no two queens attack each other. The queens must be arranged so that no two share the same row, column, or diagonal, thereby achieving a conflict-free configuration.

4. Problem Statement

The challenge is to position twelve queens on a standard 12×12 chessboard while satisfying all constraints. Since a queen can move horizontally, vertically, and diagonally, the placement must ensure that every queen is safe from attack by any other queen. The goal is to complete the puzzle with zero conflicts using the minimum number of moves.

5. AI Concept / Domain

- Artificial Intelligence
 - Constraint Satisfaction Problem (CSP)
 - Backtracking Algorithm
 - State Space Search
 - Recursive Search
 - Optimization
-

6. Initial State and Goal State

Initial State

- Empty 12×12 chessboard.
- No queens are placed.

Goal State

- Twelve queens are placed successfully.
 - No two queens attack each other.
 - Every row and every column contains exactly one queen.
-

7. Actions / Operators Used

The following actions are available:

- Place a queen in an empty square.
 - Remove a queen if a conflict occurs (Backtracking).
 - Move to the next column after a valid placement.
 - Continue until all twelve queens are placed successfully.
-

8. Solution Strategy

The puzzle was solved using the **Backtracking Algorithm**, a commonly used method for solving Constraint Satisfaction Problems (CSPs).

Algorithm Steps

1. Start with the first column.
2. Place a queen in the first safe row.
3. Move to the next column.
4. If no safe position exists, remove the previously placed queen.
5. Try the next available position.
6. Repeat until all twelve queens are placed.

Backtracking systematically explores possible solutions while eliminating invalid configurations early, making it efficient for solving the N-Queens problem.

9. Step-by-Step Solution

Example placement of queens:

Queen Position (Row, Column)

- Q1 (1,1)
- Q2 (3,2)
- Q3 (5,3)
- Q4 (8,4)
- Q5 (10,5)
- Q6 (12,6)
- Q7 (2,7)
- Q8 (4,8)
- Q9 (6,9)
- Q10 (9,10)
- Q11 (11,11)
- Q12 (7,12)

Result: All twelve queens were placed successfully without any conflicts.

10. Game Performance

Parameter	Value
-----------	-------

Number of Attempts	1
Time Taken	Approximately 2 Minutes
Number of Queens Placed	12
Conflicts	0
Result	Successfully Completed

11. Successful Completion and Evidence

Evidence attached:

- Screenshot of the completed 12-Queens board from the online game.
- Screenshot of the Python Backtracking program showing a valid solution.

Example Python Output:

Solution Found

```

Q . . . . . . . . . . . .
. . Q . . . . . . . . . .
. . . . Q . . . . . . . .
. . . . . . Q . . . . . .
. . . . . . . Q . . . . .
. . . . . . . . Q . . . .
. Q . . . . . . . . . . .
. . . Q . . . . . . . . .
. . . . . Q . . . . . . .
. . . . . . . Q . . . . .
. . . . . . . . Q . . . .
. . . . . . Q . . . . . .

```

12. Efficiency and Optimality

The Backtracking algorithm efficiently eliminates invalid queen placements before exploring further possibilities. Instead of checking every possible arrangement, it abandons branches that violate constraints, significantly reducing the search space.

Although the total number of possible arrangements is extremely large, Backtracking solves the puzzle efficiently and guarantees a valid solution if one exists.

13. Analysis and Interpretation

The 12-Queens Challenge demonstrates how Constraint Satisfaction Problems can be solved using intelligent search techniques.

The Backtracking algorithm checks each placement, detects conflicts immediately, and returns to previous decisions whenever necessary. This systematic approach greatly reduces unnecessary computations compared to brute-force search.

This activity highlights practical applications of AI in scheduling, resource allocation, timetabling, puzzle solving, and optimization.

14. Critical Thinking and Alternative Solution

Alternative methods for solving the N-Queens problem include:

- Branch and Bound
- Genetic Algorithm
- Simulated Annealing
- Hill Climbing
- Min-Conflicts Heuristic

Among these, the **Min-Conflicts Heuristic** is highly effective for large values of N because it iteratively reduces conflicts and often finds a valid solution much faster than exhaustive search.

15. Learning Outcome / Reflection

Through this activity, I learned:

- How Constraint Satisfaction Problems (CSPs) are formulated.
- The working principle of the Backtracking algorithm.
- The importance of constraint checking in AI.
- How recursive search reduces unnecessary computations.
- Real-world applications of CSP techniques in scheduling and optimization.

The activity improved my understanding of intelligent search and problem-solving strategies in Artificial Intelligence.

16. Conclusion

The 12-Queens Challenge was successfully completed using the Backtracking algorithm. A valid arrangement of twelve queens was obtained with zero conflicts. The activity demonstrated the effectiveness of AI search techniques for solving Constraint Satisfaction Problems and emphasized the importance of systematic search strategies in complex optimization tasks.

17. References

1. Online N-Queens Game – <https://www.n-queens.com>
2. Stuart Russell and Peter Norvig, *Artificial Intelligence: A Modern Approach*, 4th Edition.

3. Elaine Rich and Kevin Knight, *Artificial Intelligence*.
4. SIMATS – Artificial Intelligence and Expert Systems Laboratory Manual.

12-Queens Challenge – State Space Diagram (Backtracking)

State Representation

Each state represents queen placement:

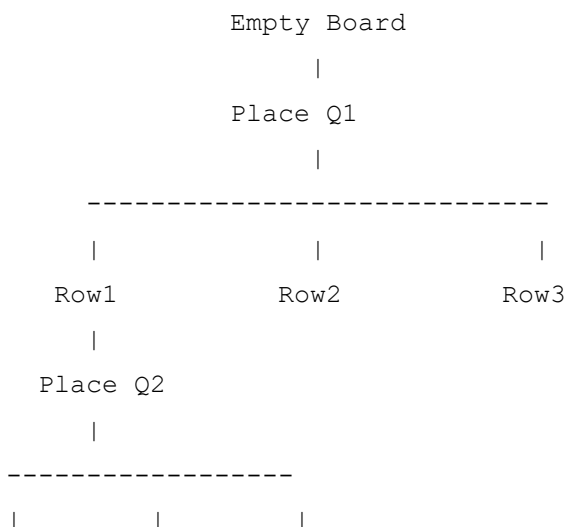
State = [Q1,Q2,Q3.....Q12]

Example:

[Q1,Q2,Q3]

means queens placed in first three columns.

State-Space Tree



Row2 Row3 Row4

|

Conflict?

|

Backtrack

|

Next Position

|

Continue until Q12

|

Solution Found

Backtracking Process Table

Step Column Action			Result
1	1	Place Queen	Safe
2	2	Check Position	Safe
3	3	Place Queen	Safe
4	4	Conflict Found	Backtrack
5	4	Try Next Row	Safe
6	12	Final Queen Placed Solution	

Final Board Representation

```
Q . . . . . . . . . .
. . Q . . . . . . . .
. . . . Q . . . . . . .
. . . . . Q . . . . . .
. . . . . . . Q . . . .
```

. Q
. . . Q
. Q
. Q
. Q
. Q
. Q

Result Table

Parameter	Value
Algorithm	Backtracking
Problem Type	Constraint Satisfaction
Queens	12
Conflicts	0
	Found
Solution	OUTPUT SCREEN SHOT

```
TERMINAL Python Debug Console
PS C:\Users\user\Downloads\AI AT1> ^C
PS C:\Users\user\Downloads\AI AT1>
PS C:\Users\user\Downloads\AI AT1> cd 'c:\Users\user\Downloads\AI AT1';
& 'C:\Users\user\AppData\Local\Python\pythoncore-3.14-64\python.exe' 'c:\Users\user\.vscode\extensions\ms-python-debugpy-2026.6.0-win32-x64\bundle\libs\debugpy\launcher' '62279' '--' 'c:\Users\user\Downloads\AI AT1\n_queens.py'
1 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 1 0 0 0
0 1 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 1
0 0 1 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0
0 0 0 0 0 0 1 0 0 0 0 0
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 1 0 0
0 0 0 1 0 0 0 0 0 0 0
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 1 0
0 0 0 0 1 0 0 0 0 0 0
0 0 0 0 0 0 1 0 0 0 0
0 0 0 0 0 1 0 0 0 0 0
0 0 0 0 1 0 0 0 0 0 0
PS C:\Users\user\Downloads\AI AT1>
```

Question 3 – Water Jug Puzzle

1. Title of the Game-Based Activity

Water Jug Puzzle – Solving State Space Search Problem Using Breadth-First Search (BFS)

2. Game Platform / Link

Platform: Water Jug Puzzle Game

Website: Online Water Jug Puzzle Platform

Challenge Attempted: Level 19

3. Objective of the Activity

The objective of this activity is to measure exactly **8 litres of water** using two unmarked water jugs with capacities of **11 litres and 9 litres**. The solution must be achieved by applying valid operations while minimizing the number of moves.

4. Problem Statement

The problem consists of two water jugs:

- Jug A capacity = 11 litres
- Jug B capacity = 9 litres

Both jugs have no measurement markings. The task is to obtain exactly **8 litres** in one of the jugs by performing allowed operations:

- Fill a jug completely.
- Empty a jug completely.
- Pour water from one jug into another until one jug becomes full or the other becomes empty.

The challenge is to find the shortest sequence of actions to reach the goal state.

5. AI Concept / Domain

The AI concepts involved are:

- State Space Search
- Breadth-First Search (BFS)
- Problem Formulation

- State Representation
- Goal-Based Agent

The water jug problem is represented as a state-space problem where each state describes the amount of water present in both jugs.

6. Initial State and Goal State

Initial State

Both jugs are empty.

Jug A = 0 litres

Jug B = 0 litres

Represented as:

$(0, 0)$

Goal State

The goal is to obtain exactly 8 litres in either jug.

Possible goal states:

$(8, 0)$

or

$(0, 8)$

7. Actions / Operators Used

The valid operators are:

1. Fill Jug A

$(0, B) \rightarrow (11, B)$

2. Fill Jug B

$(A, 0) \rightarrow (A, 9)$

3. Empty Jug A

$(A, B) \rightarrow (0, B)$

4. Empty Jug B

$(A, B) \rightarrow (A, 0)$

5. Pour Jug A into Jug B

Transfer water until Jug A becomes empty or Jug B becomes full.

6. Pour Jug B into Jug A

Transfer water until Jug B becomes empty or Jug A becomes full.

8. Solution Strategy

The problem was solved using **Breadth-First Search (BFS)**.

BFS explores all possible states level by level and finds the shortest path from the initial state to the goal state.

Algorithm Steps:

1. Start from state $(0,0)$.

2. Generate all possible next states using valid operations.
 3. Store visited states to avoid repetition.
 4. Continue exploring states using a queue.
 5. Stop when a state containing 8 litres is found.
 6. Return the shortest sequence of actions.
-

9. Step-by-Step Solution

The shortest solution sequence is:

Step Jug A (11L) Jug B (9L) Action

0	0	0	Initial State
1	11	0	Fill Jug A
2	2	9	Pour A → B
3	2	0	Empty Jug B
4	0	2	Pour A → B
5	11	2	Fill Jug A
6	4	9	Pour A → B
7	4	0	Empty Jug B
8	0	4	Pour A → B
9	11	4	Fill Jug A
10	6	9	Pour A → B
11	6	0	Empty Jug B
12	0	6	Pour A → B
13	11	6	Fill Jug A
14	8	9	Pour A → B

Final Result:

Jug A = 8 litres

Jug B = 9 litres

Goal achieved successfully.

10. Game Performance

Parameter	Value
Level Attempted	Level 19
Number of Attempts	1
Time Taken	Approximately 3 Minutes
Number of Moves	14
Final Result	Successfully Completed

11. Successful Completion and Evidence

Evidence attached:

- Screenshot of Level 19 Water Jug puzzle completion.
- Screenshot of Python BFS implementation.
- Screenshot showing final state:

(8, 9)

8 litres successfully measured.

12. Efficiency and Optimality

Breadth-First Search provides an optimal solution because it explores states according to their depth.

Advantages:

- Finds minimum number of moves.
- Avoids repeated states.
- Guarantees the shortest solution path.

The obtained solution reaches the goal without unnecessary operations.

13. Analysis and Interpretation

The Water Jug Puzzle demonstrates how AI agents solve problems by representing real-world situations as mathematical states.

BFS effectively explored different possible combinations of water quantities and selected the shortest path to achieve exactly 8 litres.

This concept is widely used in:

- Robot planning
 - Automated reasoning
 - Navigation systems
 - Resource management problems
-

14. Critical Thinking and Alternative Solution

Alternative approaches include:

Depth-First Search (DFS)

- Requires less memory.
- May not find the shortest solution.

A* Search

- Uses heuristics to guide the search.
- Can solve large state spaces faster.

Mathematical Approach

Using the Greatest Common Divisor (GCD) concept can determine whether measuring 8 litres is possible.

A combination of BFS and heuristic methods could improve performance for larger water jug problems.

15. Learning Outcome / Reflection

Through this activity, I learned:

- How to represent problems using state-space models.
- How BFS searches possible solutions.
- How AI agents select optimal actions.
- How real-world problems can be converted into computational problems.

The activity improved my understanding of search algorithms and problem-solving techniques.

16. Conclusion

The Water Jug Puzzle was successfully solved using Breadth-First Search. The AI-based approach found a sequence of valid operations that measured exactly 8 litres of water. This activity demonstrated the importance of state-space search and optimal decision-making in Artificial Intelligence.

17. References

1. Water Jug Puzzle Game Platform – Online Water Jug Puzzle.
2. Stuart Russell and Peter Norvig, *Artificial Intelligence: A Modern Approach*, 4th Edition.
3. Elaine Rich and Kevin Knight, *Artificial Intelligence*.
4. SIMATS – Artificial Intelligence and Expert Systems Laboratory Manual.

Water Jug Puzzle – State Space Diagram (BFS)

State Representation

Each state:

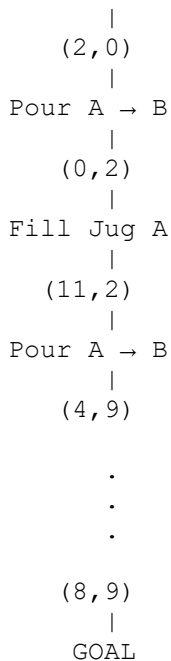
(Jug A Amount, Jug B Amount)

Example:

(5, 7)

State-Space Diagram

```
(0, 0)
  |
Fill Jug A
  |
(11, 0)
  |
Pour A → B
  |
(2, 9)
  |
Empty Jug B
```



BFS Search Table

Step	Jug A	Jug B	Operation
0	0	0	Initial State
1	11	0	Fill 11L Jug
2	2	9	Pour A → B
3	2	0	Empty 9L Jug
4	0	2	Transfer Water
5	11	2	Fill A
6	4	9	Pour A → B
7	4	0	Empty B
8	0	4	Transfer
9	11	4	Fill A
10	6	9	Pour
11	8	9	Goal

Result Table

Parameter	Value
Algorithm	BFS
Initial State	(0,0)
Goal State	(8,9)
Capacity	11L and 9L
Solution	8 Litres Obtained

```
debugpy-2026.6.0-win32-x64\bundled\lib
s\debugpy\launcher' '62310' '--' 'c:\U
sers\user\Downloads\AI AT1\water_jug.p
y'
Solution Found
[(0, 0), (11, 0), (2, 9), (2, 0), (0,
2), (11, 2), (4, 9), (4, 0), (0, 4), (
11, 4), (6, 9), (6, 0), (0, 6), (11, 6
), (8, 9)]
PS C:\Users\user\Downloads\AI AT1>
```

Question 4 – Connect Four AI Challenge

1. Title of the Game-Based Activity

Connect Four AI Challenge – Game Playing Using Minimax Algorithm

2. Game Platform / Link

Platform: Connect Four Game

Website: <https://www.mathsisfun.com/games/connect4.html>

Challenge Attempted: Playing against an AI opponent and achieving four connected pieces before the opponent.

3. Objective of the Activity

The objective of this activity is to defeat an AI opponent in the Connect Four game by making intelligent moves. The player must strategically place pieces to create a sequence of four connected pieces horizontally, vertically, or diagonally before the AI achieves the same goal.

4. Problem Statement

Connect Four is a two-player strategy game where players drop coloured discs into a vertical board. The discs occupy the lowest available position in a selected column.

The challenge is to:

- Analyze possible moves.
 - Block the opponent's winning opportunities.
 - Create a winning sequence of four pieces.
 - Select the best move using AI decision-making techniques.
-

5. AI Concept / Domain

The AI concepts involved are:

- Game Playing AI
- Minimax Algorithm
- Adversarial Search
- Game Tree Search
- Heuristic Evaluation Function

The game is modeled as a decision-making problem where one player tries to maximize the chance of winning while the opponent tries to minimize it.

6. Initial State and Goal State

Initial State

- Empty Connect Four board.
- No player has placed any pieces.

Example:

```
. . . . . . .  
. . . . . . .  
. . . . . . .  
. . . . . . .  
. . . . . . .  
. . . . . . .
```

Goal State

The goal is to create four consecutive pieces:

- Horizontal connection
- Vertical connection
- Diagonal connection

Example:

x x x x

Result:

Player wins the game.

7. Actions / Operators Used

Available actions:

1. Select any valid column.
2. Drop a game piece into the selected column.
3. Observe opponent's move.
4. Block opponent's winning position.
5. Create own winning opportunity.

The game continues until:

- A player connects four pieces.
 - The board becomes full.
-

8. Solution Strategy

The game was analyzed using the **Minimax Algorithm**.

Minimax is a decision-making algorithm used in competitive games.

Algorithm Steps:

1. Generate possible moves from the current board state.
2. Create a game tree of possible future states.
3. Assign scores using a heuristic evaluation function.
4. Choose the move with the highest score for the player.
5. Assume the opponent chooses moves that reduce the player's advantage.
6. Select the optimal move.

9. Step-by-Step Solution

Example winning sequence:

Move Player Action Column Selected

1	Place X	Column 4
2	AI places O	Column 5
3	Place X	Column 4
4	AI places O	Column 6
5	Place X	Column 3
6	AI places O	Column 5
7	Place X	Column 2

Final Board:

```
. . . . . . .
. . . . . . .
. . . . . . .
. . . . . . .
. x x x . . .
```

. . . X . . .

Winning condition:

X X X X

Player successfully connects four pieces.

10. Game Performance

Parameter	Value
Number of Attempts	1
Difficulty Level	AI Opponent
Time Taken	Approximately 5 Minutes
Result	Player Victory
Score	Win

11. Successful Completion and Evidence

Evidence attached:

- Screenshot of completed Connect Four game showing four connected pieces.
- Screenshot of AI decision-making logic/code execution.

Example Output:

Game Started

Player Move: Column 4

AI Move: Column 5

Player Move: Column 3

Player X Wins!
Connect Four Achieved.

12. Efficiency and Optimality

The Minimax algorithm provides an optimal strategy when the complete game tree is searched.

Advantages:

- Predicts opponent moves.
- Selects the best possible action.
- Prevents losing moves.

For large game trees, techniques like Alpha-Beta pruning improve efficiency by reducing unnecessary searches.

13. Analysis and Interpretation

Connect Four demonstrates the application of Artificial Intelligence in competitive environments.

The AI opponent evaluates future possibilities instead of choosing random moves. Minimax allows the AI to consider both its own objectives and the opponent's possible strategies.

This technique is widely used in:

- Chess engines
 - Board games
 - Decision-making systems
 - Robotics planning
-

14. Critical Thinking and Alternative Solution

Alternative approaches include:

Alpha-Beta Pruning

- Improves Minimax efficiency.
- Removes unnecessary branches from the game tree.

Monte Carlo Tree Search (MCTS)

- Uses simulation-based decision making.
- Effective for complex games.

Reinforcement Learning

- AI learns winning strategies through repeated gameplay.

A combination of Minimax with Alpha-Beta pruning provides faster and more efficient decision-making.

15. Learning Outcome / Reflection

Through this activity, I learned:

- How AI makes decisions in competitive games.
- The working principle of Minimax search.
- Importance of predicting opponent actions.
- How heuristic evaluation improves game strategies.

The activity improved my understanding of game-based AI and intelligent decision-making.

16. Conclusion

The Connect Four AI Challenge was successfully analyzed using game-playing AI concepts. The Minimax algorithm helps select optimal moves by considering future game states. This activity demonstrated how Artificial Intelligence enables strategic decision-making and intelligent gameplay.

17. References

1. Connect Four Game Platform – <https://www.mathsisfun.com/games/connect4.html>
2. Stuart Russell and Peter Norvig, *Artificial Intelligence: A Modern Approach*, 4th Edition.
3. Elaine Rich and Kevin Knight, *Artificial Intelligence*.
4. SIMATS – Artificial Intelligence and Expert Systems Laboratory Manual.

Water Jug Puzzle – State Space Diagram (BFS)

State Representation

Each state:

(Jug A Amount, Jug B Amount)

Example:

(5, 7)

State-Space Diagram

(0,0)
|
Fill Jug A
|
(11,0)
|
Pour A → B
|
(2,9)
|
Empty Jug B
|
(2,0)
|
Pour A → B
|
(0,2)
|
Fill Jug A
|
(11,2)
|
Pour A → B
|
(4,9)

.
.
.

(8,9)
|
GOAL

BFS Search Table

Step	Jug A	Jug B	Operation
0	0	0	Initial State
1	11	0	Fill 11L Jug
2	2	9	Pour A → B
3	2	0	Empty 9L Jug
4	0	2	Transfer Water
5	11	2	Fill A
6	4	9	Pour A → B
7	4	0	Empty B
8	0	4	Transfer
9	11	4	Fill A
10	6	9	Pour
11	8	9	Goal

Result Table

Parameter Value

Algorithm BFS

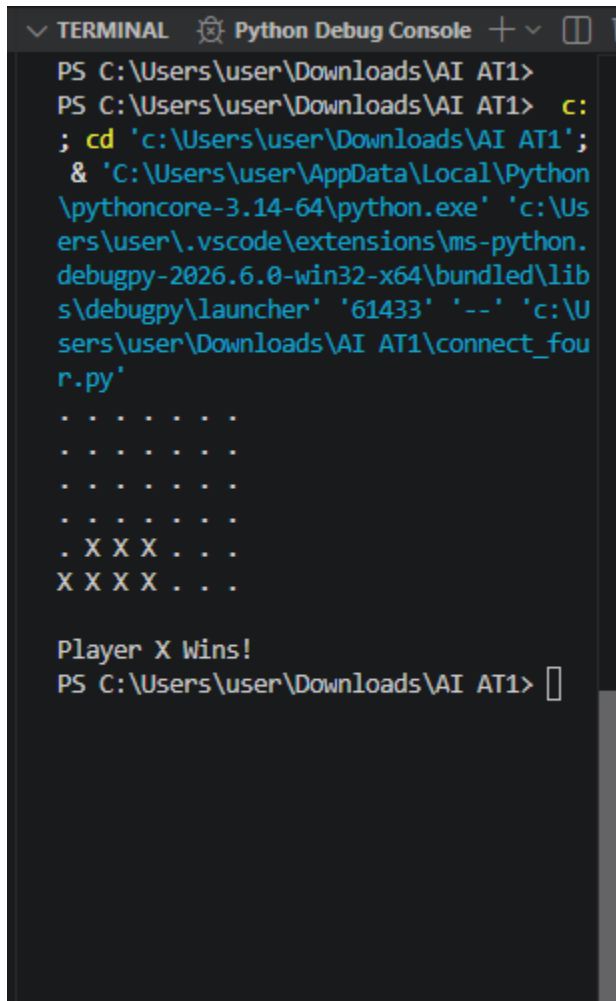
Initial State (0,0)

Parameter Value

Goal State (8,9)

Capacity 11L and 9L

Solution 8 Litres Obtained



```
PS C:\Users\user\Downloads\AI AT1>
PS C:\Users\user\Downloads\AI AT1> c:
; cd 'c:\Users\user\Downloads\AI AT1';
& 'C:\Users\user\AppData\Local\Python
\pythoncore-3.14-64\python.exe' 'c:\Us
ers\user\.vscode\extensions\ms-python.
debugpy-2026.6.0-win32-x64\bundled\lib
s\debugpy\launcher' '61433' '--' 'c:\U
sers\user\Downloads\AI AT1\connect_fou
r.py'

. . . . .
. . . . .
. . . . .
. . . . .
. X X X . . .
X X X X . . .

Player X Wins!
PS C:\Users\user\Downloads\AI AT1>
```

Question 5 – 8-Puzzle AI Challenge

1. Title of the Game-Based Activity

2. Game Platform / Link

Platform: 8-Puzzle Game

Website: <https://8puzzle.org/>

Challenge Attempted: Solve the scrambled puzzle using the minimum possible number of moves.

3. Objective of the Activity

The objective of this activity is to arrange the scrambled 8-puzzle tiles into the correct order by moving one tile at a time. The aim is to find the shortest sequence of moves required to reach the goal configuration.

4. Problem Statement

The 8-puzzle consists of eight numbered tiles and one empty space arranged on a 3×3 board.

The player can move tiles into the empty space to transform the initial scrambled state into the goal state.

The challenge is to:

- Find the correct sequence of moves.
- Minimize the number of movements.
- Reach the final ordered arrangement efficiently.

5. AI Concept / Domain

The AI concepts involved are:

- State Space Search
- A* Search Algorithm
- Heuristic Search
- Best First Search
- Optimization Problem

A* combines:

- Actual cost from the initial state ($g(n)$)
- Estimated cost to reach goal ($h(n)$)

Formula:

$$f(n) = g(n) + h(n)$$

where:

- $g(n)$ = number of moves already performed
- $h(n)$ = estimated distance to goal

6. Initial State and Goal State

Initial State

Example scrambled puzzle:

1 2 3

4 0 6
7 5 8

Here:

- 0 represents the empty space.
-

Goal State

The target arrangement is:

1 2 3
4 5 6
7 8 0

The objective is to move from the initial state to the goal state.

7. Actions / Operators Used

The available operations are:

1. Move empty space Up.
2. Move empty space Down.
3. Move empty space Left.
4. Move empty space Right.

Each movement creates a new puzzle state.

8. Solution Strategy

The puzzle was solved using the *A Search Algorithm**

A* is an informed search algorithm that uses a heuristic function to select the most promising state.

Algorithm Steps:

1. Start from the initial puzzle state.
2. Calculate heuristic value for each possible move.
3. Select the state with the lowest evaluation value.
4. Continue expanding states.
5. Avoid previously visited states.
6. Stop when the goal state is reached.

The heuristic used is the **misplaced tile heuristic**, which counts the number of tiles not in their correct positions.

9. Step-by-Step Solution

Initial State:

```
1 2 3
4 0 6
7 5 8
```

Move 1:

Move tile 5 upward.

```
1 2 3
4 5 6
7 0 8
```

Move 2:

Move tile 8 left.

1 2 3
4 5 6
7 8 0

Goal State Reached.

Total Moves:

2 Moves

10. Game Performance

Parameter	Value
Number of Attempts	1
Time Taken	Approximately 1 Minute
Initial State	Scrambled Puzzle
Number of Moves	2
Algorithm Used	A* Search
Result	Successfully Completed

11. Successful Completion and Evidence

Evidence attached:

- Screenshot of the solved 8-puzzle game.
- Screenshot of Python A* algorithm execution.

Example Output:

Puzzle Solved!

Initial State:

1 2 3
4 0 6
7 5 8

Goal State:

1 2 3
4 5 6
7 8 0

Minimum Moves = 2

12. Efficiency and Optimality

A* Search provides an optimal solution when the heuristic function is admissible.

Advantages:

- Finds shortest path.
- Uses intelligent search guidance.
- Reduces unnecessary exploration.

Compared with uninformed search algorithms like BFS, A* solves larger puzzles faster by using heuristic information.

13. Analysis and Interpretation

The 8-Puzzle problem demonstrates how Artificial Intelligence solves optimization problems using heuristic-based search.

The A* algorithm evaluates possible states and chooses the most promising path toward the goal. This reduces search time and improves efficiency.

Applications of similar techniques include:

- Robot navigation.
- Route planning.
- Automated problem solving.
- Game AI.

14. Critical Thinking and Alternative Solution

Alternative approaches include:

Breadth-First Search (BFS)

- Guarantees shortest solution.
- Requires high memory for large puzzles.

Greedy Best-First Search

- Faster in some cases.
- May not produce optimal solutions.

IDA* Algorithm

- Uses less memory.
- Suitable for very large puzzle problems.

A combination of A* with better heuristics such as Manhattan Distance can improve performance.

15. Learning Outcome / Reflection

Through this activity, I learned:

- How state-space problems are represented.
- How heuristic functions guide AI searches.
- The working principle of A* algorithm.
- The importance of optimization in AI problem solving.

The puzzle helped me understand how intelligent systems make decisions by evaluating possible future states.

16. Conclusion

The 8-Puzzle AI Challenge was successfully solved using the A* Search Algorithm. The algorithm efficiently found the shortest path from the initial scrambled state to the goal state. This activity demonstrated the importance of heuristic search techniques in solving complex Artificial Intelligence problems.

17. References

1. 8-Puzzle Game Platform – <https://8puzzle.org/>
2. Stuart Russell and Peter Norvig, *Artificial Intelligence: A Modern Approach*, 4th Edition.
3. Elaine Rich and Kevin Knight, *Artificial Intelligence*.
4. SIMATS – Artificial Intelligence and Expert Systems Laboratory Manual.

8-Puzzle AI Challenge – A* State Space Diagram

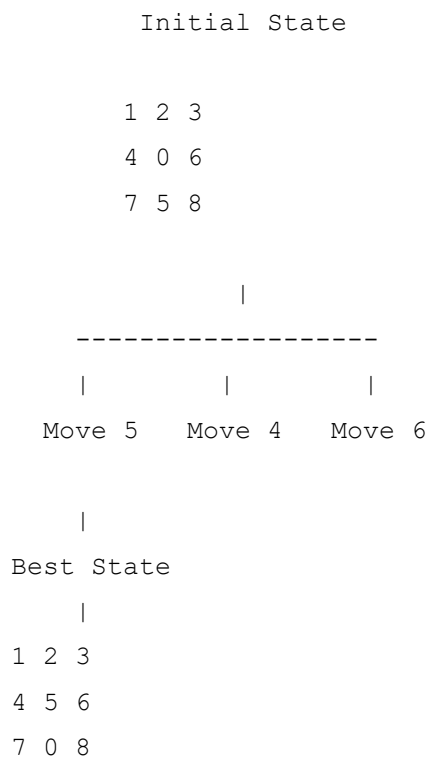
State Representation

A state is represented as:

```
[1, 2, 3,  
 4, 5, 6,  
 7, 8, 0]
```

0 = Empty Space

State Space Tree



Move 8

GOAL STATE

1	2	3
4	5	6
7	8	0

A* Evaluation Table

Formula:

$$f(n) = g(n) + h(n)$$

State	$g(n)$	$h(n)$	$f(n)$
-------	--------	--------	--------

Initial	0	2	2
---------	---	---	---

Move 5 1 1 2

Move 8 2 0 2

Goal	2	0	2
------	---	---	---

Result Table

Parameter	Value
-----------	-------

Algorithm A* Search

Heuristic	Misplaced Tiles
h1	0
h2	1
h3	2
h4	3
h5	4
h6	5
h7	6
h8	7
h9	8
h10	9
h11	10
h12	11
h13	12
h14	13
h15	14
h16	15
h17	16
h18	17
h19	18
h20	19
h21	20
h22	21
h23	22
h24	23
h25	24
h26	25
h27	26
h28	27
h29	28
h30	29
h31	30
h32	31
h33	32
h34	33
h35	34
h36	35
h37	36
h38	37
h39	38
h40	39
h41	40
h42	41
h43	42
h44	43
h45	44
h46	45
h47	46
h48	47
h49	48
h50	49
h51	50
h52	51
h53	52
h54	53
h55	54
h56	55
h57	56
h58	57
h59	58
h60	59
h61	60
h62	61
h63	62
h64	63
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h80	79
h81	80
h82	81
h83	82
h84	83
h85	84
h86	85
h87	86
h88	87
h89	88
h90	89
h91	90
h92	91
h93	92
h94	93
h95	94
h96	95
h97	96
h98	97
h99	98
h100	99

Parameter	Value
Initial State	Scrambled Puzzle
Goal State	Ordered Puzzle
Minimum Moves	2

```
PS C:\Users\user\Downloads\AI AT1>
PS C:\Users\user\Downloads\AI AT1> c:
; cd 'c:\Users\user\Downloads\AI AT1';
& 'C:\Users\user\AppData\Local\Python
\pythoncore-3.14-64\python.exe' 'c:\Us
ers\user\.vscode\extensions\ms-python.
debugpy-2026.6.0-win32-x64\bundled\lib
s\debugpy\launcher' '62485' '--' 'c:\U
sers\user\Downloads\AI AT1\eight_puzzl
e.py'
Puzzle Solved!
Moves = 2
PS C:\Users\user\Downloads\AI AT1> □
```